



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

Ryan Fernando



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Quinoa biryani, anyone?

The author **reimagines the multicultural menu** from a recent wedding, infusing it with a healthy twist.

In Indian weddings, while the grandiose clothes and elaborate decorations are certainly a highlight, it is often the food that steals the show.

The sumptuous spreads and diverse flavours are a testament to India's rich culinary heritage. It was no different at the wedding of Anant Ambani and Radhika Merchant, a dazzling affair of opulence and grandeur that left everyone in awe.

The food menu at the reception was nothing short of extraordinary. Renowned chefs from around the world were flown in to create a culinary spectacle. Among them were Chef Massimo Bottura, famous for his innovative Italian cuisine; Chef Nobu Matsuhisa, renowned for his exquisite Japanese dishes; and Chef Alain Ducasse, a maestro of French gastronomy. With over 2,500 dishes served, the event was a gastronomic extravaganza.

Celebrities from around the world indulged in the culinary delights, but it's essential to remember that your body is the most expensive real estate you'll ever own. Maintaining a healthy diet is crucial for them.

If I were tasked with making the menu healthier, here's how I would approach it, especially considering the Ambanis' preference for vegetarian cuisine.

Italian Cuisine

Truffle Risotto (Chef Massimo Bottura)

Healthier Version: Quinoa Truffle Risotto — Replaced arborio rice with quinoa to increase protein content and reduce glycemic load.

Protein: 12g per serving; Carbs: 45g per serving

Classic Margherita Pizza

Healthier Version: Cauliflower Crust Margherita Pizza — Used a cauliflower crust to reduce carbs and increase fiber content.

Protein: 10g per slice; Carbs: 20g per slice

Japanese Cuisine

Sushi Platter (Chef Nobu Matsuhisa)

Healthier Version: Brown Rice and Vegetable Sushi — Substituted white rice with brown rice and added more vegetables for fiber and vitamins.

Protein: 8g per roll; Carbs: 30g per roll

Tempura

Healthier Version: Baked Vegetable Tempura — Baked instead of deep-fried to reduce fat content.

Protein: 4g per serving; Carbs: 25g per serving

French Cuisine

Coq au Vin (Chef Alain Ducasse)

Healthier Version: Mushroom and Lentil Coq au Vin — Replaced chicken with lentils and mushrooms to create a vegetarian version rich in protein and fiber.

Protein: 15g per serving; Carbs: 40g per serving

Crème Brûlée

Healthier Version: Greek Yogurt Brûlée — Used Greek yogurt instead of heavy cream to reduce fat and increase protein.

Protein: 10g per serving; Carbs: 20g per serving

Middle Eastern Cuisine

Falafel

Healthier Version: Baked Falafel — Baked instead of deep-fried to reduce fat content.

Protein: 6g per serving; Carbs: 18g per serving